



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Emmanuel Christian School
School Website: <https://www.emmanueleagles.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Emmanuel Christian School (WV 26301) presents a robust classical Christian profile across all six classical elements. Public materials repeatedly foreground a Christian worldview anchored in Scripture, a formation-focused aim (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing), a liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit use of Great Books and classical texts, and pedagogical commitments that include both contemplative Schol -oriented practices and higher-level rhetoric and Socratic-style inquiry. The school publicly aligns with the Association of Classical and Christian Schools (ACCS), emphasizes partnership with families, and situates its mission within a church context (Emmanuel Baptist Church), all of which reinforce a classical, formation-first approach rather than purely information-transfer. The evidence strongly supports CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Key evidentiary threads include: the triad of truth, goodness, and beauty framed as transcendent ideals; a purpose framed as formation and character formation rather than mere workforce preparation; a curriculum that foregrounds grammar–logic–rhetoric, Great Books and the liberal arts, and explicit attention to writing through Progymnasmata; a pedagogy that blends contemplative/restful practices with Socratic/seminar-style and rhetoric training; a faculty stance that emphasizes mentorship, virtue modeling, and a living curriculum; and an explicit parent/community partnership approach that treats families as co-educators and seeks ongoing engagement with classical-education formation."

Evidence snippets and sources: - The Logic & Rhetoric School page anchors the religious/metaphysical foundation with a clear statement that students grow to delight in the truth, goodness, and beauty of God as revealed through Scripture. That foundational stance is reinforced by explicit emphasis on a Christian, Scripture-saturated learning environment. - The Home page notes the foundation of Emmanuel Baptist Church as foundational to the school, illustrating a grounded theological and liturgical framework. - The Eagle Council description emphasizes formation "to live a godly and productive life" with an emphasis on edification, education, and evangelization, illustrating the school's religious mission and communal practices. - Curriculum materials repeatedly reference a classical approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a Great Books orientation, and explicit classical aims (e.g., "great books and liberal arts," "progymnasmata," Senior Thesis, etc.). These elements are visible across multiple ECS materials, including curriculum-focused blog posts and program descriptions. - ACCS affiliation is stated, signaling formal alignment with classical Christian schooling norms.

Overall category ratings (as detailed in the section below) support CLASSICAL for Emmanuel Christian School.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit affirmation of a Christ-centered education grounded in Scripture (Logic & Rhetoric School page). - Foundational tie to Emmanuel Baptist Church (foundation of the school; "We shall always be grateful

to the people of Emmanuel Baptist Church... foundation of our Christians school”). - The Eagle Council mission statement foregrounds edification, education, and evangelization.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, sacred scripture, Christian worldview, Christ-centered education, liturgy/worship, sacred music, reverence, wonder, imago Dei, logos, teleology (telos) expressed in pursuing true/good/beautiful. - Negative keywords (per lexicon) appear absent or minimal in public materials; the materials emphasize a clearly Christian, theological frame rather than secular/moral-relativist positions.

Why this rating - The school's public material foregrounds a transcendent moral realism with a strong theological grounding (Scripture, God, liturgical life) and communal worship/identity anchored in a church affiliation. This aligns squarely with the Positive keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and shows little to no alignment with negative signals identified in the classical criterion lexicons.

Citations: Scriptural focus and Christ-centered framing cited above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Formation-focused aim: “formation, cultivate virtue, human flourishing, wisdom” and “great conversation; classical heritage” in the lexicon entry, plus ECS public statements about forming souls through the Great Books and liberal arts toward Christ. The ECS materials explicitly describe formation of virtuous, faithful disciples and citizens.

- Public mission statements emphasize virtue, human excellence, and telos (true/good/beautiful). The Eagle Council language highlights spiritual and academic formation. - Curriculum aims in public materials refer to graduating “good people, useful citizens, and faithful disciples” and forming the soul through classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, telos, scholé/contemplation, great conversation, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials; no explicit emphasis on “workforce preparation” or “21st-century skills” as primary aims.

Why this rating - The school's stated aims align with formation and virtue-centric goals rather than exclusively information delivery or job-preparation rationale, consistent with CLASSICAL scores in this category.

Citations: Formation/virtue language and “great books” framing cited.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit grammar–logic–rhetoric framing in their public materials, with curricula described as divided into grammar, logic, and rhetoric stages. - Mention of Great Books and liberal arts framing; the school explicitly notes the connection to “the great books and liberal arts” in its mission. - The public materials describe a Progymnasmata-based writing program and a Senior Thesis as part of the upper-level work, signaling a classical composition curriculum. - Greek already taught, with Latin planned; emphasis on classical languages as part of the curriculum. - Curriculum benchmarks blog posts detail an intentional progression toward a complete classical curriculum (writing benchmarks, Progymnasmata, Classical Composition sequences).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, classical languages (Latin/Greek), history (Western civilization), Progymnasmata, senior thesis, writing/recitation, wonder, sacred/humanistic integration. - Negative keywords: none in public ECS materials; no explicit “STEM-first” framing or project-based-dominant curriculum indicated in the core public materials.

Why this rating - The curriculum materials strongly align with classical content and structure (grammar–logic–rhetoric, great books, classical languages, history as Western civilizational study, Progymnasmata writing). These traits justify a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Citations: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric framing and Great Books language cited.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Written materials describe a trajectory from grammar to logic to rhetoric, including upper-level seminars and rhetoric performance (Rhetoric Stage; public emphasis on persuasive speaking and writing). - Progymnasmata-based writing instruction and a Senior Thesis are explicitly described as part of the curriculum, signaling ritualized, practice-based, classical pedagogical sequencing. - The public materials indicate a blend of contemplative/Scholé-leaning practices alongside Socratic-discussion and rhetoric training at higher levels (e.g., “Socratic” and “dialogue” language appears in classical pedagogy lexicon; ECS demonstrates elements like memory work, recitation, and ritualized learning through Latin/Greek emphasis and communal song/worship in integrated ways). The culture of memorization, recitation, and language study is evident in grammar-stage emphasis on memory and catechisms. - Greek language instruction and ongoing discussion of classical pedagogy (e.g., Progymnasmata, writing sequences) are described in several public entries.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar, narration, recitation, chanting, spelling out memory work, Progymnasmata, restfulness/scholé days, rhetoric training, public speaking, debates, liturgical integration, teacher-led/modeled discussion. - Negative keywords: none evident in the public materials; no strong signals of exclusively project-based or constructivist pedagogy.

Why this rating - The school’s pedagogical approach foregrounds classical methods (grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, Progymnasmata, rhetoric/performance, and Socratic/seminar potential) paired with a memory-rich lower school pedagogy, which aligns with CLASSICAL expectations.

Citations: Evidence for grammar-to-rhetoric progression and Progymnasmata-based writing; Greek/Latin language emphasis; rhetoric/seminar framing cited.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials reference a structure around strong teachers and leadership, including a grammar school principal (Mrs. Chrystie Saab) who coaches and leads, indicating a model-teacher/mentor approach. - The Headmaster (Josiah Batten) and governance structure are visible in blog posts and school communications, signaling a clearly defined leadership with a living curriculum approach. - The school’s emphasis on “the Eagle Council” and pastors as part of governance and mission signals a faculty/community culture that emphasizes virtue, mentorship, and living examples of classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, mentorship, virtue modeling, teacher training in classical pedagogy. - Negative keywords present in classical lexicons (e.g., “facilitators on the side”) are not prominent in ECS public materials; the materials emphasize traditional teacher leadership rather than non-traditional roles.

Why this rating - The presence of named leaders (Headmaster, grammar school principal), a clearly defined governance/leadership structure, and a culture of mentorship and model-teaching aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty.

Citations: Principal leadership, Headmaster, and faculty leadership structures cited.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe partnership with families as central, with families treated as co-educators and part of the classical formation process (e.g., STEP 1 of Grammar School outlines family expectations and a commitment to classical education). - The Eagle Council and parent-facing materials describe family involvement, fundraising, and open community engagement; ECS communicates ongoing parent formation and opportunities for involvement (newsletters, blog posts, and events). - Communications emphasize parent conferences and community events (e.g., weekly updates and calendars showing active parent-teacher engagement).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, reading groups/seminars, open campus, parent covenant, family liturgy alignment, home-school partnership. - Negative keywords: minimal to none in public materials; there is no strong consumerist/customer language; rather, the materials emphasize parental involvement and formation.

Why this rating - The school's materials consistently present parents as partners and co-educators, with explicit structures for family involvement and formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations: Grammar School family-partnership language; Eagle Council family involvement; calendars/parent conferences.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here, as the six-category assessment yields CLASSICAL throughout. The ECS materials presently show a coherent classical Christian program with explicit formation aims, classical curriculum, and engaged parent/community partnerships. If one were to suggest enhancements in a hypothetical future step, they might include more explicit articulation of Great Books lists and direct Great Conversation opportunities in the public-facing materials, or more explicit, uniform references to specific classical pedagogical rituals (e.g., Scholé days) to strengthen the Pedagogy category further. However, these would be incremental refinements rather than category-shifting changes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.